



High-Paying Remote Opportunities for a Multilingual Tech Professional

Where to Find Work – Platforms & Opportunities

Specialized AI Training Platforms: Leverage your Chinese, English, and Japanese skills on platforms focused on AI model training and evaluation. For example, **Outlier AI** is a well-known platform where freelancers serve as AI **trainers/evaluators**. Outlier AI boasts a network of 700,000+ experts (MAs, PhDs, etc.) and claims to have paid out over **\$500 million** to its freelance AI trainers ¹. It offers fully remote, flexible projects in **prompt writing, model feedback, and multilingual QA**, with **competitive pay and weekly payouts** ². Such platforms actively seek *language experts* and subject specialists – their community includes numerous “*Language Experts*” alongside coders and STEM experts ³. Your fluency in Chinese and Japanese makes you a strong candidate for projects that require evaluating AI outputs or crafting prompts in those languages (e.g. checking a chatbot’s answers in Mandarin or Japanese for accuracy and tone).

Mid-to-High Paying Crowdfork Sites: Traditional AI data annotation companies like **Appen**, **TELUS International AI (Lionbridge)**, **Welocalize**, and **RWS** have *AI evaluator* or *search engine evaluator* roles that are remote and often **language-specific**. These platforms frequently offer projects such as **search result evaluation, content moderation, or translation quality rating** in Chinese or Japanese. While these gigs are more “crowdfork,” the bilingual requirements mean pay is higher than generic micro-tasks (often around **\$14–\$20 USD/hour in the US/UK** for language-specific raters). For instance, Welocalize’s AI division (Welo Data) provides **multilingual AI training data** to big tech and relies on a global network of 500,000+ linguists and domain experts ⁴ ⁵. **Tip:** Stick to these reputable platforms and avoid ultra low-paid sites like MTurk; specialized language tasks on Appen or TELUS are a better use of your skills.

Freelance Marketplaces (Tech Projects): With your fullstack web development and entry-level AI experience, you can find project-based work on platforms like **Upwork** or **Freelancer**, but target higher-budget postings. Create a profile emphasizing your **multilingual ability** and AI/web portfolio – for example, advertise as a “*ChatGPT Prompt Engineer & Web Developer (English/Chinese/Japanese)*” to attract clients needing international AI solutions. Skilled prompt engineers on freelance platforms commonly charge **\$50–\$125/hour** ⁶, and those with niche expertise (e.g. regulated industries or Retrieval-Augmented Generation pipelines) can command \$150+/hour ⁶. You might start around \$40–\$60/hour on Upwork given your experience, then raise rates as you gain projects and reviews. **Toptal** is another avenue – it’s a vetting-heavy network for top freelancers; if you pass their screening, you can land remote contracts with **US/EU clients** at premium rates (often \$50+ per hour for developers). In short, **freelancing allows you to set higher prices for in-demand skills**, especially since you offer AI + web dev + multilingual capabilities.

Competitive Coding & Data Science Platforms: For project-like opportunities, consider **online competitions and bounty platforms**. **Kaggle** (for data science/AI) and **Topcoder** (for coding, data science, and design) are two premier examples. Kaggle hosts ML competitions that typically run ~3 months with

prize pools from \$25,000 up to \$100,000 ⁷. Winning top spots isn't easy, but even placing in the top 10% can earn some prize money and significantly boost your resume (especially if you leverage your Japanese/Chinese knowledge on localization or NLP challenges). **Topcoder**, on the other hand, offers both contests **and** gig work. Many Topcoder coding challenges have prizes for 1st and 2nd place (e.g. ~\$1000 and \$500), and active competitors can win multiple in a month. In fact, a Topcoder blog noted that doing ~8 challenges a month (with ~25% win rate) could yield about **\$2,750 monthly** ⁸. Moreover, Topcoder's *Gig Work* program connects freelancers to longer-term remote contracts; they highlight that top members can earn **up to \$3,000 per week** on gig assignments ⁹ (full-time equivalent contracts in web dev, data science, etc.). These platforms are merit-based and **remote-friendly worldwide**, making them great for a self-taught developer with competitive drive. You might also explore **AICrowd** or **Zindi** (for AI competitions, often with smaller prizes or "bounties" for solving AI challenges). While competition winnings are not a guaranteed income, **consistent participation can surpass \$2k in some months** if you secure wins, and they serve as excellent learning and networking opportunities.

Why These Roles Fit Your Profile

Multilingual Advantage: Your native Chinese and fluent Japanese open doors to tasks that most engineers cannot do. *Multilingual LLM evaluation* is in high demand – AI companies need people to test and fine-tune models in languages beyond English. For example, prompt/response evaluations in Mandarin or Japanese, translation accuracy checks, or cross-lingual consistency tests are all tasks where **being trilingual is a valuable asset**. Many AI projects specifically recruit bilingual raters (e.g. a job post for "*AI Model Evaluator – English (Multilingual)*" or "*Japanese AI Response Evaluator*" will require fluency in those languages). By being in the US/UK/Canada with these language skills, you qualify for roles like "*Mandarin AI Content Reviewer*" or "*Japanese Localization QA for Chatbots*" that pay more than typical single-language roles. Moreover, platforms like Outlier AI explicitly seek language experts – they showcase experts like "Danish Language Expert" or "Dutch Language Expert" as key contributors ¹⁰ ¹¹. **Why it fits:** You can provide culturally nuanced feedback that improves AI outputs in Chinese/Japanese, which adds huge value for companies deploying global AI products. This niche leverages your language ability daily – something standard dev jobs might not.

Technical & Analytical Skills: With a mechanical engineering degree and self-taught fullstack development, you have strong analytical and problem-solving skills – ideal for tackling diverse freelance projects. **Mechanical engineering** training means you're comfortable with math, complex systems, and logical thinking, which is a boon in AI model tuning and data science competitions. It also means you could handle domain-specific tasks (e.g. if a competition or freelance project involves sensor data, physics simulations, or technical writing, your background helps you stand out). Your fullstack web development experience means you can prototype solutions end-to-end, an ability that's useful in many contexts: for instance, a Kaggle competition might require not just modeling but also building a demo app, or a Topcoder gig could be to develop a web tool – you can do both coding and understand the AI behind it. **Why it fits:** The roles suggested (from RLHF evaluator to platform competitor) often require a mix of skills – writing prompts, understanding AI behavior, coding scripts, or debugging outputs. Your combined software and data science knowledge enables you to take on those tasks confidently, whereas someone with only one of those skills might struggle. Additionally, your ability to self-learn new tech will help you adapt to the rapidly evolving AI tools used in these gigs.

Remote-Only Preference: All the opportunities listed are fully remote and flexible. Short-task platforms (Outlier, Appen/TELUS, etc.) let you work from home on your own schedule, which suits your desire for

remote-only work. Similarly, freelance projects and competitions are inherently remote – you submit work online and collaborate via Slack or forums. Your profile (located in a Western country but multilingual) is actually ideal for remote work; you can interface with international clients easily thanks to your English proficiency, while delivering work in Chinese/Japanese when needed. The roles also allow you to **avoid relocation** or commuting, aligning with your lifestyle preference. Importantly, by targeting mid-to-high paying platforms, you steer clear of the notorious low-paid gigs – you won't be stuck doing penny-per-task translation or \$5 bug fixes. Instead, you'll engage in substantial tasks (like evaluating an AI's answers or building a solution for a \$50K competition) that **respect your skill level and pay accordingly**.

What Tasks to Focus On – Roles & Project Types

Given your interests, here are **specific task types and roles** that match your skillset and can earn good pay:

- **Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback (RLHF) Reviewer / AI Evaluator:** This involves providing feedback on AI model outputs to help train better models (for example, reviewing a chatbot's answer for quality, or ranking multiple responses by preference). As a **RLHF reviewer** or **prompt evaluator**, you might be writing challenging prompts, creating scoring rubrics, and then grading AI responses against those rubrics ¹² ¹³. In practice, you could be asked to prompt an AI in Chinese or Japanese and assess how well it follows instructions, or to compare an English answer vs. a Japanese answer for correctness. These tasks are **short and discrete** – perfect for part-time freelance work. They fit you because you can leverage your languages (e.g. testing if a Japanese query yields an accurate result) and your technical understanding (to judge if the AI's answer is logically sound). **What to do:** Sign up on platforms like Outlier AI (or similar AI data firms) and complete their qualification process. Once approved, you'll pick from available projects (for example, a project might be "Evaluate AI translations for 10 hours this week" or "Rate AI-generated answers in Japanese"). Ensure you maintain high accuracy/quality scores – many platforms reward quality with bonuses ² and doing well keeps you on the roster for more tasks. *Example tasks:* RLHF raters have reported work like "prompt an AI with five different tricky questions, create an evaluation rubric, then rate several model answers" ¹⁴ ¹⁵. With your expertise, you might design prompts that involve technical content (leveraging engineering knowledge) or idiomatic language nuances (leveraging native Chinese). This role is **excellent for supplemental income** on a flexible schedule.
- **Multilingual LLM Tester / Prompt QA Specialist:** In this role, you function as a **quality assurance tester for AI models**, focusing on multilingual capabilities. Companies launching chatbots or generative AI in global markets need people to "*break*" the model in various languages – essentially, *find where it fails or produces inappropriate output*. Your job would be to run the model through scenarios in Chinese and Japanese (and English) to ensure it's robust. For instance, you might do **prompt QA** by asking the AI culturally specific questions in Japanese or inputting Mandarin slang, then verifying the answers aren't gibberish or harmful. If issues are found, you document them for the developers. This is akin to *LLM safety auditing*: ensuring the model's safety filters and accuracy hold up across languages. **What to do:** Look for contract openings titled "*Localization QA for AI*", "*Multilingual AI Quality Specialist*", or even postings on AI communities (the AI startup sphere often hires contractors for model evaluation). These could be short engagements (e.g. a few weeks of testing before a product launch) or recurring gigs when models update. Given the recent findings that **AI safety doesn't reliably transfer across languages** ⁴ ¹⁶, this area is growing – many organizations realized that a chatbot safe in English might misbehave in another language, so they need testers like you. By focusing on this, you help companies patch those "*blind spots*". This role fits

your profile because it taps both your language fluency and your attention to detail/analytical skills developed from engineering. It's a bit like being an ethical hacker but for language: you try to jailbreak the AI by using non-English input or tricky phrasing. Many future **"LLM Safety Auditor"** jobs will likely require exactly this skillset (multilingual + tech savvy), positioning you ahead of the curve.

- **Prompt Engineer / Creator (Multilingual focus):** Prompt engineering has become a recognized specialty – designing and refining the text prompts or instructions that yield the best AI responses. As someone fluent in multiple languages and proficient in coding/AI basics, you can carve out a niche as a **multilingual prompt engineer**. This could involve creating prompts that get an English-based model to output in perfect Japanese, or developing prompts that help an AI understand Chinese cultural context. Additionally, you could participate in **prompt-based hackathons or bounty programs**. For example, some platforms or research labs host competitions for the best prompts or chains of prompts that improve an AI's performance on a task. There's also an emerging concept of **"prompt marketplaces"** where people are paid for high-quality prompts. **What to do:** Build a portfolio of effective prompts in your languages (e.g. show how you can prompt GPT-4 to summarize a Japanese article in English flawlessly, or to output code comments bilingual in Chinese/English). You can freelance by offering prompt engineering services – companies might hire you to optimize their prompts for local languages. Pay can be quite high here (as noted, experienced prompt engineers often get **\$50+ per hour or six-figure salaries** ⁶). This role fits you because it sits at the intersection of language and AI tech. Moreover, prompt engineering is something you can self-teach and demonstrate easily online (no formal credentials needed – results speak for themselves). Given your programming background, you can also incorporate tools like Python scripts or prompt frameworks to systematically test prompts, which adds to your value.
- **Data Science Competitor or Bounty Hunter:** On platforms like Kaggle, AICrowd, or even open innovation sites (like HeroX or Innocentive), you can tackle project-based challenges. For Kaggle competitions, you'll download a dataset and develop an ML model to achieve the best predictions; for Topcoder challenges, you might write code to meet a spec or solve an algorithmic problem. Some newer "bounty" platforms offer **rewards for specific AI tasks** – for instance, solving a specific problem (e.g. improving an AI translation model for a rare language) or finding biases in a model (**bias bounty** programs). *Why focus here?* Because you have a unique blend of skills: you can code, you understand AI enough to build simple models or pipelines, and you bring a perspective from a different domain (mechanical engineering) which can be advantageous for certain problem types (like engineering simulations or physics-based data). **What to do:** Identify competitions that you find interesting and which might benefit from your skillset. Since you're aiming for income, target those with substantial prizes or those sponsored by companies (they tend to have higher rewards). Form or join a team if possible – teaming up can improve your odds of winning and you might collaborate with others who complement your skills (e.g. you provide web deployment skills, they provide heavy ML theory). Outside of Kaggle, keep an eye on announcements of **AI hackathons** or government tech challenges in the US/Canada – many now have themes like "build an AI to do X" with prizes or even contract awards. Additionally, **Topcoder Gig Work** (discussed earlier) is essentially project freelancing but with Topcoder's mediation – if competitions aren't steady enough, applying for a Topcoder gig (e.g. a 3-month remote contract building a fullstack app for \$4,000/month) can be a great project-based income source. Overall, this track fits you if you enjoy project variety and a bit of competition – it's a way to earn money **per project** rather than per hour, which sometimes can exceed \$2,000 in a single shot if you win a prize.

- **Higher-Level Freelance Dev/Data Projects:** Don't overlook applying your skills in **fullstack development or data analysis** for higher-paying gigs that incorporate AI. For example, a client on Upwork might need a *web application that integrates an AI language model* – with your background, you could handle both the front-end/back-end and the AI API integration. These projects can pay in the thousands of dollars for a few weeks of work. Similarly, you might find **consulting contracts** where a company wants to localize their software for China/Japan – you could be hired as a freelance developer who also advises on Chinese localization and even implements an AI-based translation feature. **What to do:** Browse categories like “Machine Learning”, “Chatbot Development”, or “Web Development” on freelance sites, and filter for hourly rates or budgets that are mid/high range. Pitch yourself emphasizing that you bring a “*trifecta*” of skills (engineering rigor, software dev, language expertise). These gigs might be less “short-task” and more like part-time jobs, but a single good client could easily give you \$2,000+ per month of work. Given you want remote-only and flexibility, you can negotiate part-time hours. This path fits you well because it leverages **all parts of your profile** and helps avoid doing the repetitive low-end tasks – you'd be solving real problems for businesses, which is more engaging and better paid.

Income Range & Earning Potential

Short-Task AI Evaluation: Roles like AI content evaluator or RLHF rater typically pay **\$20–\$35 per hour** for English-only work, and sometimes more for advanced degrees or multilingual tasks. For example, a recent posting offered **\$30/hour base** for remote AI content review (flexible schedule) ¹⁷. As a trilingual evaluator, you might find projects that pay a premium (some specialized evaluations or urgent projects can even approach \$40/hour). However, note that these tasks are usually gig-based – you might get, say, 10–20 hours of work in a week when a project is active, but not consistently full-time. According to freelance workers' reviews, platforms like Outlier AI have **great pay when projects are available** but work can be inconsistent ¹⁸. In other words, you could feasibly make a quick \$500 in a week or two on a project, but then wait for the next one. If you sign up with multiple agencies (e.g. Appen, TELUS, Outlier, RWS) and stay active, you increase your chances of having continuous tasks. **Monthly potential:** Many people treat this as supplementary income – earning **\$1,000–\$2,000 in a busy month** is feasible by piecing together various tasks, but it might not be steady every month. The key is to grab higher-paying, skill-based tasks (like AI prompt evaluation in Chinese) and avoid the penny-per-task stuff. Quality-centric platforms may also give bonuses; e.g., some have “performance pay” where top annotators get extra – this can bump your effective hourly pay higher if you excel.

Freelance Projects & Marketplaces: On Upwork or similar, income can vary wildly, but since you are targeting *middle-to-high* end gigs, let's consider realistic scenarios. If you land a project at, say, \$50/hour for 10 hours a week, that's \$500/week, which is **\$2,000 per month** – and that's a fairly conservative scenario for an experienced fullstack developer with AI skills in the current market. Many clients will pay **\$60–\$100/hr for experienced talent** (especially for niche skills like prompt engineering or multi-language support), so two 15-hour/week projects at \$60/hr would net ~\$7,200 in a month. Project-based fees can also be lucrative: for instance, a contract might be \$5,000 to build a web tool due in one month – if you can execute it efficiently, that's a solid one-month income. **Typical ranges:** As a benchmark, prompt engineering freelancers often charge between **\$50 and \$125 per hour** ⁶. Web developers on high-end platforms (Toptal, etc.) command around **\$80/hour** on average ¹⁹ ²⁰. If you join Toptal or Topcoder Gig Work, full-time engagements can pay on the order of **\$100k+ annually** (Topcoder gigs advertised up to \$3k/week which is ~\$12k/month for full-time commitments) ⁹. Given you only need \$2k+ per month, you could

achieve that with one decent part-time contract. The challenge initially is securing those clients – but once you do, the income is well above piecemeal task work.

Competitions & Bounties: Income here is not salary but prize-based. A **single win** in a Kaggle or Topcoder challenge can be anywhere from a few hundred dollars to tens of thousands. For example, a 1st place in a medium Kaggle competition might be \$10,000 (teams often split prizes) ²¹, and Topcoder design/dev challenges often pay ~\$500 for second place ⁸. If you're consistently in the top ranks, you could realistically average a couple thousand per month from prizes, as some competitive members do. Topcoder's own analysis suggested a full-time competitor could average **\$2,750/month by winning about 25% of the challenges they attempt** ⁸. There are also **long-term contests** and bounty programs – for instance, a **"bias bounty"** might reward participants who find critical AI biases with a few hundred dollars each, or a **hackathon** prize could be \$5k for the winner. These are not guaranteed income streams, but they can significantly supplement your earnings. Plus, sometimes placing well leads to job offers or freelance contracts (companies sponsor competitions to scout talent). **For your planning:** consider competition earnings as "bonus" income – one month you might win \$0, another month you could win \$5,000. It's hard to predict, so don't rely on it for steady bills, but over a year you could target maybe **\$10k+ from competitions** if you dedicate some time and pick those that play to your strengths (for example, an NLP challenge where knowing Chinese gives you an edge in data understanding).

Overall Outlook: Combining these avenues, it's very possible to reach or exceed your \$2,000/month goal while staying fully remote. For example, you might be doing ~10 hours/week of AI evaluation tasks (say \$30/hr) = ~\$1,200/month, and a small web freelance project for \$1,000, plus occasionally a competition win. Or you may land a single contract at \$2,500/mo that covers it. The mix-and-match approach often works for freelancers: ensure you have a **baseline gig** (something like a part-time contract or steady AI rating job) that provides the core income, and then layer on shorter tasks or competitions as available for extra cash. Because you are avoiding the bottom-of-the-barrel gigs (where people toil for \$3/hour which is unsustainable), every hour you work is high-value, meaning you can work fewer hours for the same income – this is great for preventing burnout and giving you time to learn and pursue the next opportunity.

Future Trends & Insights – Staying Ahead

The tech landscape is evolving rapidly, especially in AI, and your unique skill combo positions you well for emerging roles. Here are some future trends to watch (and prepare for):

- **Multilingual Prompt Engineering & AI Interaction Design:** As large language models become ubiquitous, companies will seek professionals who can design prompts and conversational flows *across languages*. We're already seeing prompt engineers transition into titles like *"AI Interaction Designer"* or *"Prompt QA Lead"* ²². In the near future, having expertise in prompting in Chinese or Japanese could make you the go-to person for global AI behavior design. You might, for instance, help ensure that an AI legal assistant works just as well in Japanese as it does in English by crafting culturally adapted prompt templates. **Insight:** Keep improving your prompt skills and stay updated on prompt tooling (like new frameworks for evaluating prompt quality). This field will likely formalize, with possibly certifications or communities focusing on multilingual prompting. By contributing to open-source prompts or writing about your cross-language prompt experiments now, you could establish yourself as an expert in this niche before it gets crowded.

- **LLM Safety Auditing & Bias Bounties:** We touched on the need for multilingual AI safety testing – this is poised to grow into a recognized specialization. The fact that **safety filters can be bypassed via other languages** ¹⁶ ²³ has raised concern; it's not just hypothetical, but a real "safety liability" per recent research. This means organizations (from Big Tech to governments) will invest in "*red teams*" or auditors to probe AI systems for vulnerabilities in non-English contexts. Already, nonprofit and industry initiatives are launching "**bias bounty**" **challenges** to find biases or harms in AI models, similar to how cybersecurity bug bounties operate ²⁴. For example, challenges on platforms like Zindi are being organized to crowdsource bias detection in AI for various languages ²⁵. **Insight:** This is a great way for you to get involved and gain visibility. Participating (and succeeding) in a bias or safety bounty not only earns rewards but also showcases your expertise in a hot topic. It could lead to consulting gigs where you are hired to audit an AI system for, say, racial bias in its Japanese outputs or misinformation in Chinese results. Keeping an eye on Responsible AI forums and multilingual AI research (like the Welo Data study we cited) will help you stay at the cutting edge. In the long run, "*AI Safety Specialist – Multilingual*" could become a formal job title, and you'd be well qualified for it.
- **AI-Enhanced Localization and Internationalization:** Traditional translation/localization jobs are being transformed by AI. Rather than hiring large teams of translators, companies might use LLMs to do 90% of the work and then hire bilingual experts (like you) to do **prompt-based localization**. This means knowing how to prompt an AI to output text that is not just translated but culturally appropriate. We foresee **multilingual AI content creators** becoming a thing – e.g., using generative AI to create marketing content in multiple languages, with human experts guiding the tone/style. Since you have both tech and language skills, you could capitalize on this by offering services to businesses expanding into Asia: you can implement the AI solution *and* ensure the output reads naturally in Chinese/Japanese. **Insight:** Tools like OpenAI's GPT and others will likely have improved multi-language support, but they will still need human steering. By staying informed on AI localization tools (like OpenAI's fine-tuning in other languages, or translation startups that use AI), you can position yourself as a "*localization engineer*." This hybrid role could command higher rates than traditional translation because it's tied to deploying tech.
- **Fusion of Web Dev and AI (Full-Stack AI Developer):** There's a trend towards embedding AI into all sorts of software. Your full-stack background combined with AI means you're effectively a **full-stack AI developer** – capable of building an application and integrating machine learning into it. Future freelance marketplaces and startups will highly value such multi-skilled individuals. Imagine being the sole developer who can create a web app **and** implement an AI feature like a recommendation engine or a chatbot in one of three languages – that's cost-effective for a client to hire one person instead of three. **Insight:** Continue sharpening both your web dev and AI skills simultaneously. Learn frameworks for deploying AI models (FastAPI, Flask for model APIs, etc.) and stay updated on JavaScript/Frontend as well. Many "AI dev" roles in the near future will expect developers to be comfortable calling AI APIs or even training small models. By being ahead on this, you'll qualify for higher-paying projects or roles that seek "jack of all trades" developers. This could also lead to opportunities in remote AI startups who need someone that wears multiple hats (engineer, data wrangler, and language specialist).
- **Continuous Learning & Community Involvement:** Finally, a general trend is that AI and tech are moving so fast that what's lucrative today could change in a year or two. The best way to stay in the middle-to-high pay zone is to keep learning **and signal your expertise**. This might mean getting an

advanced certification in data science or a specialization in NLP. It could also mean actively participating in communities (Kaggle forums, freelance groups, AI Discords) to hear about new gigs or trends early. For example, if a new platform launches that pays people to **train multimodal AI** (text+images) and they need Japanese speakers – being active in the right community could get you in on the ground floor. **Insight:** Treat your skillset as an evolving product – invest time each week to learn something new (a new ML technique, a new framework, a bit of Japanese NLP research, etc.). This ensures you can move into emerging high-pay roles. Already, job titles like “*LLM Systems Architect*” or “*AI Evaluation Specialist*” are appearing ²² – which combine engineering savvy with understanding of AI behavior. That’s essentially what you are building yourself into. In a few years, you could be consulting as an independent expert in AI systems evaluation, billing companies \$100/hour for your unique mix of skills.

In conclusion, your language abilities and technical background give you a **competitive edge** in the remote freelance market. By targeting the platforms and roles above, you can avoid the underpaid grind and focus on **meaningful, well-compensated work** – whether it’s guiding AI in multiple languages, competing in high-stakes challenges, or developing cutting-edge applications. Keep an eye on the trends, stay flexible, and continue to **network across cultures** (sometimes being active in Chinese or Japanese tech forums can surface opportunities Western platforms don’t see). With this approach, earning \$2,000+ per month remotely should not only be attainable, but you may find yourself exceeding that as you capitalize on these emerging opportunities. Good luck, and happy freelancing!

Sources:

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